ECON 100B

Intermediate Macroeconomics

Summer Session II 2026 · Synchronous Online · All times Pacific

INSTRUCTOR
Yuchao Li
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OFFICE HOURS
Tu 4:45–6:45 PM
Zoom link on Canvas

The course at a glance

LECTURES	Tu/Th 1:00–4:30 PM (online)	**PREREQUISITES**	ECON 1 and ECON 2; *and* ECON 11B, AM 11B, MATH 22, or MATH 23A
ZOOM	Links on the Canvas *Zoom* tab	**TEXTBOOK**	Jones, *Macroeconomics*, 5th ed.
SECTIONS	One per week, required	**MIDTERM**	Tuesday, August 11, 1:00 PM
ATTENDANCE	Required, camera on, for lectures *and* sections	**FINAL**	Thursday, August 27, 1:00 PM

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Before you enroll: this course uses Respondus LockDown Browser with Monitor

Every exam is proctored with **Respondus LockDown Browser** and its webcam component, **Respondus Monitor**. You will need a **webcam, a microphone, a stable internet connection** and a **photo ID**. Tablets may not be used in this course, and **no alternative arrangement is available**. The full requirements are in §5.

1 Course Information

Teaching team

ROLE	SECTION	OFFICE HOURS
Instructor (Yuchao Li)	—	Tu 4:45–6:45 PM
Teaching assistant	A · W 6:00–7:00 PM	W 2:00–4:00 PM
Teaching assistant	B · Th 5:00–6:00 PM	F 11:00 AM–1:00 PM

Zoom links for the lecture, for both sections, and for every office hour above are on the **Zoom tab** in Canvas.

Lectures and sections

- **Lectures** meet **Tu/Th 1:00–4:30 PM**, live over Zoom.
- **Attendance is required at all lectures, and you must attend at least one section each week.** TAs work through questions from the assignments *before* they are due, so you can guarantee full credit on that part of the assignment by attending sections and following closely.
- Sign in to Zoom with your **full first and last name** as listed on the course roster, register for the lecture, and keep your **video on**. Add a profile picture to your Zoom account.
- Join on time and stay attentive, as you would in an in-person lecture.
- All forms of communication in Zoom are allowed — raise your hand, unmute your mic, or type in the chat.

Materials and workload

- **Textbook.** Charles I. Jones, *Macroeconomics*, 5th edition.
- **Canvas.** Announcements, lecture slides, and all assignments live on Canvas; slides are posted before each lecture.
- **Workload.** In a typical week, expect to spend 7 hours in lectures, 5 hours reading, 1 hour in section, and 2 hours on homework.

Getting help

Your success matters to me, but class size and time are limited, so a few guidelines keep things working for everyone.

- **Ask during lecture.** If you are confused or curious, others almost certainly are too — so

please **interrupt me a lot during class**.

- **Come to office hours** — mine or your TA's. If you cannot make the scheduled time, email me to set up an appointment.
- **Email is a last resort.** Detailed written answers take a long time to compose, so my replies will be brief; without back-and-forth I often cannot tell what you are really asking; and responses may be delayed, especially right before an exam.

2 Course Description

This course analyzes the aggregate, or "macro," behavior of the US economy, in two parts.

- **The long run.** The factors that determine aggregate income, saving, and consumption over long horizons, with a special focus on theories of economic growth.
- **Short-run business cycles.** What drives booms and recessions, how unemployment and inflation move over the cycle, the New Keynesian account of those movements, and the role of monetary and fiscal policy in stabilizing the economy.

The goal is to equip you with the core models used to analyze the macroeconomy over both horizons, and to make you comfortable interpreting macroeconomic data through the lens of those models. By the end of the course you will be able to:

1. Analyze the aggregate behavior of the US economy within a coherent framework.
2. Explain monetary and fiscal policy responses to short-run and long-run problems.
3. Interpret US macroeconomic data through the lens of the main macro models.
4. Read and critically analyze articles from prominent economics journals, applying economic theory and principles in your analysis.

3 Grading

COMPONENT	WEIGHT
Lecture attendance · video on, up to 2 absences	5%
Short in-class activities · three lowest dropped	15%
Problem sets · 5 total, lowest dropped	20%
Midterm	25%
Final	35%
Total	**100%**

Re-grading

If you believe something was graded incorrectly or unfairly, you have **one week** from the class in which it was returned to submit a **written** request to the TAs. Verbal requests are not accepted. When an assignment or exam is turned in for a re-grade, **the entire exam is re-graded**, and the scores for individual questions can be either increased or decreased. Remaining disagreements may be appealed to me.

4 Assignments

Problem sets

There will be **five problem sets**, graded coarsely: check plus, check, check minus. Working through them — and genuinely understanding how to solve them — is how you prepare for the exams. Some will involve downloading and analyzing US macroeconomic data.

- Submit through **Canvas Assignments in a readable format**. After uploading, confirm the file can be downloaded. We grade only work correctly uploaded to Canvas by the due date. **Email submissions are not accepted.**
- You are encouraged to discuss problem sets with classmates, but **you must write up your own solutions**. You may *not* consult solutions circulating online or from previous years — doing so is cheating.

Short in-class activities

Each class includes a **short quiz** on the topics covered that week. **You must attend class to take it.**

5 Exams and Proctoring

Midterm	Tuesday, August 11, 1:00 PM, during the regular class period
Final	Thursday, August 27, 1:00 PM, during the regular class period

Exam dates are fixed commitments. **We cannot offer make-up exams or reschedule set exam dates.** Before enrolling, make sure you are available on both dates — and if you have concerns about the proctoring requirement below, the recommended course of action is to speak with your advisor and withdraw, then take the course under normal testing procedures in the in-person format offering.

Proctoring requirements

Exams are given on Canvas and proctored with **Respondus LockDown Browser** and its webcam component, **Respondus Monitor**, which you will be required to download. **There are no alternatives and no exceptions.** Tablets may not be used for exams in this course; further setup instructions will be posted on Canvas.

1. **Photo ID.** A government or school ID with your picture — passport, driver's license, school ID — must be presented on screen to the proctor for recording at each exam. **You cannot take the exam without it.**
2. **Webcam and connection.** You must use a computer with a webcam, which records you throughout the exam; I may review that video to verify the integrity of the test. Take the exam in a quiet place free of distractions, on a strong, reliable, encrypted internet connection — not an unencrypted public hotspot.
3. **Restricted environment.** The software limits or monitors access to websites, other applications, and study materials during the exam. It is your responsibility to know which additional resources, if any, are permitted and to stay within those limits. Violations of the testing restrictions or policy can affect your exam score.
4. **Compatibility check.** You may be asked to complete a sample test in the proctoring system at least **48 hours before the first exam** to confirm that your computer is compatible and working properly.

Exam content

You may not reproduce, distribute, or display — including posting or uploading — any of an exam's content, whether or not a fee is charged, and you may not allow others to do so. Sharing exam content or communicating with others during an exam violates the academic integrity policy for this course and will result in a failing grade.

6 Course Schedule

Background reading: Chapter 1, *Introduction to Macroeconomics*.

	DATE	READING AND TOPICS
Part I · The Long Run		Chapters 2–6 · what determines income, saving, and growth over long horizons
1	**Tu July 28**	Ch. 2 — Measuring the Macroeconomy GDP by production, expenditure, and income; real versus nominal output; the GDP deflator; what the national accounts leave out.
2	**Th July 30**	Ch. 3 — An Overview of Long-Run Economic Growth Growth rates and ratio scales; the constant-growth rule; US growth facts and cross-country income differences.
3	**Tu Aug. 4**	Ch. 4 — A Model of Production The Cobb–Douglas production function; diminishing returns; solving the model; total factor productivity and development accounting.
4	**Th Aug. 6**	Ch. 5 — The Solow Growth Model • Ch. 6 — Growth and Ideas Capital accumulation and the Solow diagram; steady state and transition dynamics; ideas as nonrival goods; the Romer model; growth versus level effects.
	Tu Aug. 11	**MIDTERM EXAM** · 1:00 PM · no lecture this day
Part II · The Short Run		Chapters 8–13 · booms, recessions, and the role of stabilization policy
5	**Th Aug. 13**	Ch. 9 — An Introduction to the Short Run • Ch. 11 — The IS Curve Short-run output and potential output; the business cycle and Okun's law; an overview of the short-run model; consumption, investment, and the real interest rate; deriving the IS curve.
6	**Tu Aug. 18**	Ch. 11 — The IS Curve, continued Aggregate demand shocks and shifts in the IS curve; the multiplier; using the model to read recessions.
7	**Th Aug. 20**	Ch. 12 — Monetary Policy and the Phillips Curve The MP curve and the IS–MP diagram; the Phillips curve; the sticky-inflation assumption; disinflation.
8	**Tu Aug. 25**	Ch. 8 — Inflation • Ch. 13 — Stabilization Policy and the AS/AD Framework The quantity theory of money and monetary neutrality; the Fisher equation; the AS and AD curves; macroeconomic events in the AS/AD framework.
	Th Aug. 27	**FINAL EXAM** · 1:00 PM

Exam dates are fixed. Topics are tentative; the current daily outline is maintained on Canvas.

7 Academic Integrity and AI

Everyone at UCSC benefits from an environment of trust, honesty, fairness, respect, and responsibility. You are expected to present your own work and to acknowledge the work of others.

Integrity includes

- Following exam rules.
- Using only permitted materials during an exam.
- Viewing exam materials only when permitted.
- Keeping what you know about an exam to yourself.
- Properly citing all sources.
- Submitting your own original work.

Misconduct includes, but is not limited to

- Disclosing exam content during or after an exam.
- Accessing exam materials without permission.
- Submitting material copied or purchased from another student or source as your own.
- Plagiarism, including uncited internet material.
- Using phones or other electronics for outside information during an exam without my explicit permission.
- Self-plagiarism — submitting work done for another class without prior permission.

Violations can result in dismissal from the university and a permanent notation on your transcript. For the full policy and disciplinary procedures, see the Academic Misconduct page at the Division of Undergraduate Education.

AI policy

The use of artificial intelligence tools (e.g. ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini) is **strictly prohibited for all types of assignments.**

- **Permitted:** using AI tools to brainstorm and build conceptual understanding of high-level ideas — roughly, the way you would ask a colleague. Note that these tools may hallucinate information, and they may not provide truthful insights or information. These uses are permitted **only outside of** (1) assignments and (2) quizzes and exams.
- **Not permitted:** using AI-generated sources for any reason to complete assignments, discussions, quizzes, or exams. If you submit an exam that appears to be written with AI sources, I will ask you to meet with me to discuss your answers. If, after that conversation, I conclude it is more likely than not that you did not personally complete an assignment you submitted under your name, I may refer you to your college provost for further conversation.

8 Support and Required Notices

Accessibility

UC Santa Cruz is committed to an academic environment that supports its diverse student body. If you are a student with a disability who requires accommodations to achieve equal access in this course, please affiliate with the Disability Resource Center. If you are already affiliated, make sure you have requested Academic Access Letters for the courses where you intend to use accommodations, and please meet with me privately — in office hours or by appointment — as early as possible, so we can discuss how to implement them.

Title IX and CARE

UC Santa Cruz is committed to a learning environment free of gender discrimination and sexual harassment, both prohibited under Title IX. If you have experienced sexual harassment, sexual assault, domestic violence, dating violence, or stalking, you are not alone, and the resources below can support you.

If you tell me about a situation involving Title IX misconduct, I am required to share that information with the Title IX Coordinator. This applies equally to course TAs and tutors, and to all UCSC employees who are not designated "confidential" — a designation held by counselors and CARE advocates. Although I must make that notification, **you control how your case is handled**, including whether to pursue a formal complaint.

Confidential support is available through CARE: advocates will not share information with Title IX, the police, your parents, or anyone else without your explicit permission, and they can help you understand your rights and options, access health and counseling services, obtain academic and housing accommodations, and pursue legal protective orders.

Campus resources

RESOURCE	WHAT IT IS FOR	CONTACT
CARE	Confidential advocacy and support	(831) 502-2273 care@ucsc.edu
Title IX Office	Reporting gender discrimination, harassment, and violence	(831) 459-2462 Reporting tool
SAFE	Working out what resources you or someone else may need	safe.ucsc.edu
CAPS	Confidential counseling, crisis intervention, and mental health screenings	(831) 459-2628
Disability Resource Center	Accommodations and Academic Access Letters	(831) 459-2089 drc@ucsc.edu

RESOURCE	WHAT IT IS FOR	CONTACT
Slug Support	Basic needs — housing, food, financial insecurity — and technology for remote instruction, through the Dean of Students Office	(831) 459-4446 deanofstudents@ucsc.edu
Learning Support Services	Tutoring, Modified Supplemental Instruction, and writing support for undergraduates	Website
ITS Support Center	Any technology or computing problem	help@ucsc.edu
UC Police Department	Reports to law enforcement	(831) 459-2231 ext. 1
Emergencies	Immediate danger; health center and emergency services	**911**

Difficult conversations

Our discussions will take up challenging, high-stakes issues, and they will not always be easy. We will sometimes make mistakes in our speaking and in our listening, and will need patience, courage, and respect for one another. An important aim of our classroom interactions is to build our facility with difficult conversations — about social justice, politics, economics, morality, and religion — where reasonable people hold diverse views.

Course feedback

At the end of the term you will be asked to complete a Student Experience of Teaching survey. This anonymous feedback is how I learn what to change for future students.